

permitted by surface modeling is essential for the evolution of 3D printers as it allows for fully finished objects to be printed, that require little or no finishing or detailing once they are fabricated.

By combining the best of industrial solid modeling programs and commercial surface modeling design programs, 3D printers are able to not only fabricate an object that is accurately functional but also polished in its detailing and appearance. The combined harmony of shape and appearance programing using CAD programs makes the potential of 3D printing truly achievable.

Major Commercial Softwares

The following are some of the major industry used commercial 3D printing softwares.

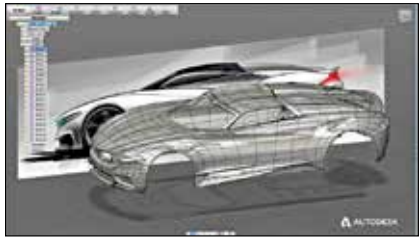
Autodesk Softwares

3DS Max, AutoCAD and Maya are the three most commonly used 3D modeling and design softwares currently in exist-

ence and pioneered by the Autodesk Media and Entertainment Company. They are often used in tandem or separately depending on the nature of the design project and the degree of complexity required. They each have their specialised area of function and can be used for a variety of functions besides 3D printing. But from an industry standpoint they are the foundational softwares of 3D printing.

Autodesk 3DS Max is the most advanced of all the softwares used for 3D printing. Originally created as a 3D computer graphics product used in 3D animation, modeling and graphic design, it is a vast architecture of versatile plugins and features that make it a powerful 3D printing tool. It's use in cutting edge animation and video game design due to its advanced texture mapping and surface modeling options make it optimally suitable to handle complex 3D printing projects.

It is currently available as a free student's version which has all the features of the expensive commercial version. It lasts for three years beyond which it needs to be reinstalled on a student's license or purchased. It can only be used for non-commercial educational purposes. It is usually bundled with other



The detailing and definition through surface modeling makes designs more than just an odd shape that resemble a car.